

Farid Akram Sawaqed

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EDUCATION

Montclair State University, Montclair, NJ May 2025
M.A. | Computer Science | 3.6

Montclair State University, Montclair, NJ May 2024
CERT | Game Development | 4.0

Montclair State University, Montclair, NJ May 2021
B.A. | Mathematics | 3.4 - Dean's List (Spring 2018, Fall 2019, Fall 2020)

EXPERIENCE

Newark School of Data Science and Information Technology, Newark, NJ October 6, 2025 – Current
Per Diem Teacher

- Provide classroom instructions for grades 9 to 12 in various subjects as needed.
- Maintain a positive and organized environment by following lesson plans and adapting to diverse classroom settings.
- Manage student behavior effectively while ensuring safety and engagement.
- Communicate with staff and administration to support student learning.

Montclair State University, Montclair, NJ September 3, 2024 – May 5, 2025
Graduate Research Assistant

- Sponsored by The National Science Foundation
- Research on emotion-based human-robot interaction to implement the creation of an Artificially Intelligent Assistant.
- Attend weekly lab meetings to report and discuss projects' progresses.
- Produce and present research outcomes through academic papers, oral presentations, and posters at Montclair State University, as well as at national/international conferences.

September 5, 2023 – May 7, 2024

Game Development Certificate Teaching Assistant

- Tutor up to 25 students a semester in Blender about Mesh Creation, Rigging, Animation, and export to game engines.
- Evaluate students' progress during class and help them with their specific needs.
- Grade assignments while providing constructive feedback to students to aid in their learning experience.
- Maintain office hours where students can come and get help related to game development.

LEADERSHIP AND HONORS

- **Treasurer, Game Development Club** (2022 – 2024): Became the first Treasurer of the Game Development club after becoming one of the leading students in the Game Development courses.

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

- **Computer Skills:** Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), Unreal Engine, Unity, Java, Python, C#, C++
- **Languages:** Arabic (native), English (advanced), Spanish (intermediate)
- **Illustration:** Art with a focus on anatomy, buildings, and perspective, proficient in Blender, Aseprite, and Procreate.

Projects

- **Websites:** Created several projects including portfolios, a DnD initiative Tracker, and others for learning purposes.
- **Indie Games:** Completed up to 5 computer games of different categories for learning purposes, as well as a collaboration project that includes 3 different minigames.
- **Blender:** Created several different meshes that can be used for new games and can be 3D printed for house display.